“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 11

The Description of the Branches of the Nityānanda Trunk

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. The eleventh chapter describes the associates of Nityānanda Prabhu.

Obeisances to the associates of Nityānanda —

নিত্যানন্দপদাম্ভোজ-ভৃঙ্গান্ প্রেমমধুন্মদান্ ।
নত্বাখিলান্ তেষু মুখ্যা লিখ্যন্তে কতিচিন্ময়া ॥ ১ ॥

nityānanda-padāmbhoja-
of Nityānanda of the feet lotus-

bhṛṅgān prema-madhunmadān
the bees by the honey of love maddened

natvākhilān teṣu mukhyā
having bowed to all among them the chief

likhyante katicin mayā
are written of a few by me

1 I bow to all the devotees who, like bees at the lotus feet of Nityānanda, are maddened by the honey of love, and I shall write of a few, the foremost among them.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I bow down to all the bees at Nityānanda's lotus feet, who are maddened by drinking the honey of love, and I will name a few of the chief devotees among them.

Anubhāṣya.

prema-madhūnmadān (maddened by honey, and that honey is *prema* itself) **akhilān** (all) **nityānanda-padāmbhoja-bhṛṅgān** (the bees at the Prabhu's lotus feet) **natvā** (having bowed down to) **teṣu katicit mukhyāḥ** (the chief devotees) **mayā likhyante**.

জয় জয় মহাপ্রভু শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য ।
তাঁহার চরণাশ্রিত যেই, সেই ধন্য ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya mahāprabhu śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya
glory glory Mahāprabhu Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
tāṁhāra caraṇāśrita yei, sei dhanya
His sheltered at the feet whoever, he is blessed

2 Glory, glory to Mahāprabhu Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! Whoever has taken shelter at His feet is truly blessed.

জয় জয় শ্রীঅদ্বৈত, জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয় জয় মহাপ্রভুর সর্ব্বভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ৩ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-advaita, jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Advaita, glory to Nityānanda
jaya jaya mahāprabhura sarva-bhakta-vṛnda
glory glory of Mahāprabhu to all the devotees

3 Glory, glory to Śrī Advaita! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory, glory to all the devotees of Mahāprabhu!

Description of the branches of Nityānanda's trunk —

তস্য শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য-সৎপ্রেমামরশাখিনঃ ।
ঊর্দ্ধস্কন্ধাবধূতেন্দোঃ শাখারূপান্ গণান্নুমঃ ॥ ৪ ॥

tasya śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-
of that Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya-
sat-premāmara-śākhinaḥ
eternal love undying tree
ūrddhva-skandhāvadhūtendoḥ
the high trunk the Avadhūta moon
śākhā-rūpān gaṇān numaḥ
as branches the devotees we bow to

4 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the undying tree of eternal love, and its tall trunk is the Avadhūta, Śrī Nityānanda, beautiful as the moon. I bow to His devotees, the branches of that trunk.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the wish-fulfilling tree of prema, and Śrī Avadhūta Nityānanda-candra is its high trunk. I bow down to His associates, the branches of that trunk.

Anubhāṣya.
śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-sat-premāmara-śākhinaḥ (Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is Himself the eternally existing [*sat*] tree of prema, the immortal, imperishable tree named Gaura; **tasya**, of Him) **ūrdhva-skandhāvadhūtendoḥ** (the high trunk is Nityānanda Prabhu, and He is also the moon; of Him) **śākhā-rūpān gaṇān numaḥ** (we bow down).

By Mahāprabhu's will, Nityānanda's branch grows and becomes foremost —

শ্রীনিত্যানন্দ-বৃক্ষের স্কন্ধ-গুরুতর ।
তাহাতে জন্মিল শাখা-প্রশাখা বিস্তর ॥ ৫ ॥

śrī-nityānanda-vṛkṣera skandha-gurutara
Śrī Nityānanda of the tree trunk mighty
tāhāte janmila śākhā-praśākhā vistara
on it grew branches offshoots in abundance

5 Śrī Nityānanda is the mighty trunk of the tree, and on it grew branches and offshoots in great number.

মালাকারের ইচ্ছা-জলে বাড়ে শাখাগণ ।
প্রেম-ফুল-ফলে ভরি' ছাইল ভুবন ॥ ৬ ॥

mālākārera icchā-jale bāḍe śākhā-gaṇa
the gardener's by the water of will grow the branches
prema-phula-phale bhari' chāila bhuvana
with flowers and fruits of love filled covered the world

6 The branches grow by the water of the gardener's will. Laden with the flowers and fruits of love, they have covered the world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Of the gardener": of Śrī Mahāprabhu.

অসংখ্য অনন্ত গণ কে করু গণন ।
আপনা শোধিতে কহি মুখ্য মুখ্য জন ॥ ৭ ॥

asaṅkhya ananta gaṇa ke karu gaṇana
countless endless devotees who can count
āpanā śodhite kahi mukhya mukhya jana
myself to purify I tell the chief chief persons

7 The devotees are numberless, without end — who could count them all? For my own purification I shall name only the foremost.

(1) The branch of Śrī Vīracandra Gosāñi —

শ্রীবীরভদ্র গোসাঞি — স্কন্ধ-মহাশাখা ।
তাঁর উপশাখা যত, অসংখ্য তার লেখা ॥ ৮ ॥

śrī-vīrabhadra gosāñi — skandha-mahāśākhā
Śrī Vīrabhadra Gosāñi of the trunk the great branch
tāṁra upaśākhā yata, asaṅkhya tāra lekhā
His offshoots as many, countless their record

8 Śrī Vīrabhadra Gosāñi is the great branch of the trunk, and the offshoots that spring from Him are beyond counting.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Vīrabhadra Gosāñi was the son of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu and a disciple of Mother Jāhnavā; He was born of Vasudhā. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 67): "That *vyūha* of Saṅkarṣaṇa named Payobdhiśāyī became Vīracandra, who is not different from Caitanya." His disciple was Yadunātha Ācārya of the village of Jhāmaṭapura in Hugalī district. Vīrabhadra married Yadunātha's daughter Śrīmatī, born of Vidyunmālā (Lakṣmī), and also their adopted daughter Nārāyaṇī; see the *Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 13. Three of His disciples, Gopījana-vallabha, Rāmakṛṣṇa and Rāmacandra, became famous as His sons. The youngest, Rāmacandra, lived in Khaḍadaha; he was a Śuddha-śrotriya of the Śāṇḍilya *gotra* with the surname "Baṭabyāla." The eldest, Gopījana-vallabha, lived in the village of "Latā" near Mānakara in Barddhamāna district, and the middle one, Rāmakṛṣṇa, in Gayeśapura near Māladaha. If all three share the same *gotra* and the same village, no one can doubt that they were Vīrabhadra's sons by birth. Rāmacandra had four sons. The third son of the eldest, Rādhāmādhava, was Yādavendra; his son was Nandakiśora; his son, Nidhikṛṣṇa; his son, Caitanya-cāđa; his son, Kṛṣṇamohana; his son, Jaganmohana; his son, Vrajanātha; and Vrajanātha's son was the late Śyāmalāla Gosvāmī.

His glory: though Viṣṇu Himself, He behaves as a Vaiṣṇava —

ঈশ্বর হইয়া কহায় মহা-ভাগবত ।
বেদধর্ম্মাতীত হঞা বেদধর্ম্মে রত ॥ ৯ ॥

īśvara haiyā kahāya mahā-bhāgavata
the Lord being has Himself called a great devotee
veda-dharmātīta hañā veda-dharme rata
beyond Vedic dharma being in Vedic dharma engaged

9 Though He is the Lord, He calls Himself a great devotee; though He is beyond the dharma of the Vedas, He keeps faithfully to it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Vīracandra Prabhu is by nature Payobdhiśāyī, the *vyūha* of Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa, and so He is the Lord Himself. Yet He thought of Himself as a Vaiṣṇava.

অন্তরে ঈশ্বর-চেষ্টা, বাহিরে নির্দ্দম্ভ ।
চৈতন্যভক্তি-মণ্ডপে তেঁহো মূলস্তম্ভ ॥ ১০ ॥

antare īśvara-ceṣṭā, bāhire nirdambha
within the Lord's conduct, outwardly without pride
caitanya-bhakti-maṇḍape teṁho mūla-stambha
of devotion to Caitanya in the hall He the main pillar

10 Within, He acts as the Lord; outwardly, He shows no pride. He is the main pillar in the hall of devotion to Śrī Caitanya.

অদ্যাপি যাঁহার কৃপা-মহিমা হইতে ।
চৈতন্য-নিত্যানন্দ গায় সকল জগতে ॥ ১১ ॥

adyāpi yāṁhāra kṛpā-mahimā haite
even today whose of mercy by the glory
caitanya-nityānanda gāya sakala jagate
Caitanya-Nityānanda sings the whole world

11 Even today, through the glory of His mercy, the whole world sings of Caitanya and Nityānanda.

সেই বীরভদ্র-গোসাঞির চরণ — শরণ ।
যাঁহার প্রসাদে হয় অভীষ্ট-পূরণ ॥ ১২ ॥

sei vīrabhadra-gosāñira caraṇa — śaraṇa
that Vīrabhadra Gosāñi's feet — my shelter
yāṁhāra prasāde haya abhīṣṭa-pūraṇa
whose by the grace comes desires' fulfilment

12 The feet of that Vīrabhadra Gosāñi are my shelter, for by His grace every desire is fulfilled.

(2) Ṭhākura Abhirāma (gopāla 1), (3) Dāsa Gadādhara —

শ্রীরামদাস আর, গদাধর দাস ।
চৈতন্য-গোসাঞির ভক্ত রহে তাঁর পাশ ॥ ১৩ ॥

śrī-rāmadāsa āra, gadādhara dāsa
Śrī Rāmadāsa and Gadādhara dāsa
caitanya-gosāñira bhakta rahe tāṅra pāśa
of Caitanya Gosāñi devotees stayed his at the side

13 Śrī Rāmadāsa and Gadādhara dāsa, devotees of Caitanya Gosāñi, stayed at Nityānanda's side.[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Rāmadāsa is Abhirāma dāsa.

Anubhāṣya.
Gadādhara dāsa: see Ādi 10.53.

Śrī Rāmadāsa (Abhirāma). Ṭhākura Abhirāma, whose very life was Nityānanda, is one of the twelve *gopālas*; in Vraja he is Śrīdāma, [Kṛṣṇa's] friend. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 126): "He who was formerly named Śrīdāma is now the great Abhirāma, who carried a log that only thirty-two men could carry." See Ādi 10.116–118.

The *Bhakti-ratnākara* (wave 4) tells of Śrīla Abhirāma Ṭhākura. By the order of Nityānanda, the crusher of the godless, Abhirāma Ṭhākura was an ācārya and a preacher of *bhakti-dharma*. "The might of Abhirāma Gosvāmī is fierce: at the sight of him the unconquerable godless always tremble. He is ever maddened, absorbed in Nityānanda; his enchanting mercy is known throughout the world." A saying is current to this day: if he bowed down to any stone or image other than a Viṣṇu-*śilā* or a Deity of Viṣṇu, it would split and crumble to dust.

Abhirāma Ṭhākura's *śrīpāṭa* is in Khānākula-Kṛṣṇanagara, about ten miles south-west of Cāṅāḍāṅgā station on the Hāoḍā–Āmtā line, past the "Helānāra hāṭ." In the rainy season the road is flooded, so one goes by the B.N.R. line: from Kolāghāṭa by steamer to Rāṇīcaka, and from there Khānākula is 7½ miles to the north. Abhirāma Ṭhākura's *śrīpāṭa* is in Kṛṣṇanagara; because that village lies on the bank of the river Khānā, or Dvārakeśvara, it is called "Khānākula-Kṛṣṇanagara."

Outside the temple, near the gate, stands a *bakula* tree; the spot is called the "Siddha-bakula-kuñja." It is said that Abhirāma Ṭhākura sat here first when he came.

Inside the temple are Śrī Baladeva and Śrī Madana-mohana (alone, without Rādhā). On a single slab of black touchstone, 1¼ cubits high and nearly a cubit

wide, the Deity of Śrī Gopīnātha is carved together with the pastime of stealing the garments: the kadamba tree, the Yamunā, and the cows and calves. Such are the *arcā* Deities. Besides these, on the throne are a sacred image of Abhirāma Ṭhākura in the ecstasy of dance (his feet not spread apart) and Śrī Vraja-vallabha (the Divine Couple). There are also a Śrī Śālagrāma and a Deity of Śrī Gopāla. Tradition says that Śrī Abhirāma Ṭhākura found the Gopīnātha Deity while the pond in front of the temple was being dug. Since then the pond has been known as "Abhirāma-kuṇḍa." Directly south of the temple where the Deities now reside stands an old *nava-ratna* temple. A stone plaque high on that temple bears the inscription that it was built in the year 1181. The builder's name is not given. It is said that the late Nachirāma Siṁha "Gailā" of a neighbouring village had the temple built. The Deity resided here even earlier, and before the temple was built He was served on this very spot in a thatched hut.

Directly north of the Śrī Gopīnātha temple is the ancient temple of Śrī Rādhā-vallabha Jīu, founded by the local Kāyastha Caudhurīs.

The stone plaque of the present temple bears the inscription: "Śrī Śrī Gopīnātha Jīu. Temple built in the month of Māgha, year 1219. Repaired in the month of Vaiśākha, year 1308." It is said that the late Puṇḍarīkākṣa Rāya of Mādhavapura, near Ārāmabāga police station in Hugalī district, built it. In front of the old temple stands a spacious brick *nāṭya-mandira*. The fishermen (*dhīvaras*) of Medinīpura district built it in 1263; when it fell into disrepair, they restored it in 1320.

The servitors say that ever since the time of Śrīla Abhirāma Ṭhākura it has been the custom here to offer *bhoga* of parboiled (*siddha-cāula*) rice; even puffed rice (*muḍi*) is offered. Another unusual custom is that when the Ṭhākura is laid to rest, the temple doors stay open and He is laid to rest in everyone's sight. Nowadays there is no custom of performing *maṅgala-ārati* for the Ṭhākura in the morning.

At present there are thirty-six or thirty-seven families of servitors. It is said that inside the temple, in an iron chest, is kept Śrīla Abhirāma Ṭhākura's famous whip "Śrī Jayamaṅgala"; the chest is locked with all the keys of these servitors. The whip is two cubits long and wrapped in gold thread; at a festival it is brought out only when all the servitors agree together. The *Bhakti-ratnākara* (wave 4) writes of the whip "Śrī Jayamaṅgala" that love for Kṛṣṇa arose in anyone Abhirāma Ṭhākura struck with it. Once, when Śrīnivāsa Ācārya came to Abhirāma's house, Ṭhākura Abhirāma touched Śrīnivāsa's body three times with that whip. Then Abhirāma's wife, Mālinī Devī, a brāhmaṇa's daughter, laughed, took the Ṭhākura by the hand,

and said, “Ṭhākura, restrain yourself! Śrīnivāsa is a boy; at the touch of your whip he will lose all composure.”

His descendants (by birth, or in the line of disciples?) live in Kṛṣṇanagara and Āmtā in Hugalī district, and in Viṣṇupura, Kotalapura and other villages of Bāṅkuḍā district.

A certain “Abhirāmadāsa,” a disciple of Ratneśvara, gives the names and places of “Ṭhākura Abhirāma’s” disciples in his book *Śākhā-nirṇaya* as follows: (1) Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura lived in Khānākula (the line has died out); (2) a devotee named Vedagarbha lived in the village of Kaiyaḍ (about 10 miles southwest of Barddhamāna); his descendants now serve the Deity there; (3) Haridāsa lived in the village of Būṛhana (nothing particular is known of him); (4) Pākhiyā-Gopāladāsa lived in the village of Helāla (?) (about two miles north of Khānākula, on the bank of the river Khānā); a small ruined temple known as his *samāja* stands there now, but there is no Deity; (5) “Gumphanārāyaṇa” lived in the village of Pāikamājiṭā (?) near Rāmajīvanapura in Medinīpura district; his descendants are living; (6) Dāḍiyā Mohana lived in Sītānagara (neither the place nor his line can be traced); (7) Satyarāghava lived in Mayanāmuḍi (Bāṅkuḍā) (where his descendants live is unknown); (8) Rajanī Paṇḍita lived in Sālikhā (near Hāoḍā?) (where his descendants are is also unknown); (9) Sundarānanda lived in Bhāṅgāmoḍā (about 4 miles northwest of Tārakeśvara); he has descendants; (10) Kṛṣṇānanda Avadhūta lived in Dvīpagrāma (its location is unknown); it is doubtful whether he had any descendants; (11) Raṅgaṇa-Kṛṣṇadāsa lived in the village of Sonātalā (-lī) (in Hugalī or Hāoḍā district?) (the line has died out); (12) Murāridāsa lived in Māladaha (where his descendants live is unknown); (13) Mohana Ṭhākura lived in Pāṇihāṭi (nothing is known of his lineage); (14) Yadu Hāladāra lived in Rādhānagara (south of Khānākula-Kṛṣṇanagara); because his line died out, the Deity he established, Śrī Balarāma, is still served together with Śrī Gopīnātha; (15) Harimādhava lived in Anantanagara (near Khānākula) (the line has died out); (16) Gopāladāsa lived in Māheśa (near Śrīrāmapura?) (nothing is known of his descendants); (17) Acyuta Paṇḍita lived in Koṭarā (near Khānākula police station) (a descendant is living); (18) Lakṣmīnārāyaṇa lived in the village of Pāṭalā (the line has died out); (19) Gopīnāthadāsa lived in Purī (no information); (20) Nandakiśora lived in Cuṇākhāli *parganā* (near Māheśa) (nothing is known of his descendants); (21) Vidura Brahmacārī lived in the village of Pātāgrāma (Pāṭuli in Barddhamāna district?); his descendants are living; (22) Rāmakṛṣṇa lived in Vinupāḍā (nothing is known of either the place or the man); (23) Kamalākara lived in Gaurāṅgapura (about 4 miles

north of the *śrīpāṭa*); his *samāja* is nearby, and his descendants serve the Deities of Śrī Nitāi-Gaura; (24) Balarāma Ṭhākura lived in Viśvagrāma (neither the place nor the man can be traced); (24½) Śrīnivāsa Ācārya Prabhu (he was most dear to Abhirāma and received his affection and mercy, but because he had not taken initiation from him he is evidently counted as a "half disciple"). On the lunar day of Kṛṣṇa-saptamī in the month of Caitra a great festival is held here, and many people gather.

The two preach in Gauḍa together with Nitāi —

নিত্যানন্দে আজ্ঞা দিল যবে গৌড়ে যাইতে ।
মহাপ্রভু এই দুই দিলা তাঁর সাথে ॥ ১৪ ॥

nityānande ājñā dila yabe gauḍe yāite
to Nityānanda the order gave when to Gauḍa to go
mahāprabhu ei dui dilā tāṁra sāthe
Mahāprabhu these two gave Him with

14 When Mahāprabhu told Nityānanda to go to Gauḍa, He sent these two with Him.

(4) Mādhava and (5) Vāsu Ghoṣa Ṭhākura —

অতএব দুইগণে দুঁহার গণন ।
মাধব-বাসুদেব ঘোষের এই বিবরণ ॥ ১৫ ॥

ataeva dui-gaṇe duṁhāra gaṇana
therefore in both groups of both the counting
mādhava-vāsudeva ghoṣera ei vivaraṇa
of Mādhava Vāsudeva Ghoṣa the same account

15 Therefore they are counted in both groups, and so it is with Mādhava and Vāsudeva Ghoṣa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

These two are like Nityānanda's own associates. When Mahāprabhu ordered Nityānanda Prabhu to go to Gauḍa, He sent Rāmadāsa and Gadādhara dāsa with Him. So these two were counted once among Mahāprabhu's associates, and now

they are counted among Nityānanda's as well. Mādhava and Vāsu Ghoṣa are likewise counted in both groups.

Anubhāṣya.

Govinda Ghoṣa, Vāsu Ghoṣa. Govinda Ghoṣa Ṭhākura's most beloved Deity, Śrī Gopīnātha, is still present at Agradvīpa, near Dāïhāṭ and Pāṭuli in Barddhamāna district. On the day of His devotee's disappearance He offers *piṇḍa*, as a son does at his father's *śrāddha*. His service has long been carried on under the supervision of the royal family of Nadīyā-Kṛṣṇanagara. Every year in the month of Vaiśākha, at the time of the "Bāradola" in Kṛṣṇanagara, He is brought to the capital together with eleven other Deities, and after the Dola festival He is taken back to Agradvīpa.

Many *padas* in the "Gaura-nāgarī" mood, which gratify the senses of the *prākṛta-sahajiyās*, have been interpolated into Vāsu Ghoṣa's collection of *padas*. In truth these are not, and can never be, the *padas* of Vāsu Ghoṣa, a devotee of Gaura who relished the rasa of separation (*vipralambha*). *Sādhakas* will reject them. See Ādi 10.115.

Abhirāma's pastimes —

রামদাস — মুখ্যশাখা, সখ্য-প্রেমরাশি ।
ষোলসাঙ্গের কাষ্ঠ যেই তুলি' কৈল বাঁশী ॥ ১৬ ॥

rāmadāsa — mukhya-śākhā, sakhya-prema-rāśi
Rāmadāsa — a chief branch, of friendly love a treasure
ṣolasāṅgera kāṣṭha yei tuli' kaila bāṁśī
of sixteen bearers the log which lifting made a flute

16 Rāmadāsa, a chief branch, was a treasury of loving friendship. He lifted a log that it took sixteen men to carry and made a flute of it.

The extraordinary deeds of Dāsa Gadādhara —

গদাধর দাস গোপীভাবে পূর্ণানন্দ ।
যাঁর ঘরে দানকেলি কৈল নিত্যানন্দ ॥ ১৭ ॥

gadādhara dāsa gopībhāve pūrṇānanda
Gadādhara dāsa in the mood of a gopī full of bliss
yāṁra ghare dānakeli kaila nityānanda
whose in the house the toll pastime performed Nityānanda

17 Gadādhara dāsa was full of bliss in the mood of a gopī, and in his house Nityānanda revealed the *dāna-keli* pastime.[2]

Mādhava Ghoṣa's kīrtana —

শ্রীমাধব ঘোষ — মুখ্য কীর্ত্তনীয়াগণে ।
নিত্যানন্দপ্রভু নৃত্য করে যাঁর গানে ॥ ১৮ ॥

śrī-mādhava ghoṣa — mukhya kīrtanīyā-gaṇe
Śrī Mādhava Ghoṣa — foremost among kīrtana singers
nityānanda-prabhu nṛtya kare yāṁra gāne
Nityānanda Prabhu dance does whose to the singing

18 Śrī Mādhava Ghoṣa was foremost among the kīrtana singers, and Nityānanda Prabhu would dance to his singing.

Vāsu Ghoṣa's kīrtana —

বাসুদেব গীতে করে প্রভুর বর্ণনে ।
কাষ্ঠ-পাষাণ-দ্রবে যাহার শ্রবণে ॥ ১৯ ॥

vāsudeva gīte kare prabhura varṇane
Vāsudeva in songs makes of the Lord description
kāṣṭha-pāṣāṇa-drave yāhāra śravaṇe
wood stone melt whose on hearing

19 When Vāsudeva sang of the Lord, even wood and stone would melt to hear him.

(6) Murāri-Caitanyadāsa —

মুরারি-চৈতন্যদাসের অলৌকিক লীলা ।
ব্যাঘ্র-গালে চড় মারে, সর্প-সনে খেলা ॥ ২০ ॥

murāri-caitanya-dāsera alaukika līlā
of Murāri-caitanya dāsa wondrous pastimes
vyāghra-gāle caḍa māre, sarpa-sane khelā
the tiger on the cheek slap strikes, with snakes play

20 Wondrous were the pastimes of Murāri-caitanya dāsa: he would slap a tiger on the cheek and play with snakes.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Murāri-Caitanyadāsa was born in the village of Sar-Vṛndāvanapura, one *krośa* from Galaśī station in Barddhamāna district. When he came to the village of Modadruma, or Māugāchi, in Navadvīpa-dhāma, he came to be called "Śārṅga" (Sāraṅga) Murāri-Caitanyadāsa. His descendants still live at the *pāṭa* of Sar.

Anubhāṣya.

Murāri-Caitanyadāsa. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 5: "Caitanyadāsa's body has no external consciousness. He drives tigers deep into the forest, and at times he even rides on a tiger. By Kṛṣṇa's grace the tiger cannot harm him. He takes a huge python on his lap, and Caitanyadāsa fearlessly delights in it. He played with tigers without fear — such is the mercy the great Avadhūta bestows. Caitanyadāsa has entirely forgotten himself; in bliss he constantly speaks what is in his heart. For two or three days he stays submerged in water, and his body suffers no harm. In dress and behaviour he is almost like an insensible man, and no one notices him. He is wild beyond measure and boundlessly brave, like a lion. How much can I tell of the transformations of bhakti in Caitanyadāsa? They are all boundless. Such is the worthy Śrī Caitanyadāsa Murāri Paṇḍita: even by the breeze that has touched him, one surely attains Kṛṣṇa."

Nitāi's associates are pure devotees, the friends of Vraja —

নিত্যানন্দের গণ যত, — সব ব্রজসখা ।
শৃঙ্গ-বেত্র-গোপবেশ, শিরে শিখিপাখা ॥ ২১ ॥

nityānandera gaṇa yata, — saba vraja-sakhā
of Nityānanda the associates as many — all friends of Vraja
śṛṅga-vetra-gopaveśa, śire śikhi-pākhā
horn staff cowherd dress, on the head peacock feather

21 All of Nityānanda's associates are cowherd friends from Vraja. Each carries a horn and a staff and wears the dress of a cowherd, with a peacock feather on his head.

Anubhāṣya.

All the devotees who took shelter of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu took shelter of the *sakhya-rasa* of Vraja. All of them wear the dress of cowherd boys. The Prabhu's wife, the queen Mother Jāhnavā, is Anaṅga-mañjarī of Vraja, the younger sister of Śrīmatī Rādhikā. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 66): "Some say that in the age of Kali Anaṅga-mañjarī is Śrī Vasudhā-devī, while others declare her to be Jāhnavī. By the earlier principle, the saintly consider both views correct." The devotees who took shelter of Mother Jāhnavā are also counted among Nityānanda's associates.

(7) Raghunātha Vaidya —

রঘুনাথ বৈদ্য উপাধ্যায় মহাশয় ।
যাঁহার দর্শনে কৃষ্ণপ্রেমভক্তি হয় ॥ ২২ ॥

raghunātha vaidya upādhyāya mahāśaya
Raghunātha Vaidya Upādhyāya a great soul
yāṁhāra darśane kṛṣṇa-prema-bhakti haya
whose at the sight love and devotion for Kṛṣṇa arises

22 Raghunātha Vaidya Upādhyāya was a great soul: the very sight of him awakened loving devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

(8) Sundarānanda (gopāla 2) —

সুন্দরানন্দ — নিত্যানন্দের শাখা, ভৃত্য মর্ম্ম ।
যাঁর সঙ্গে নিত্যানন্দ করে ব্রজনর্ম্ম ॥ ২৩ ॥

sundarānanda — nityānandera śākhā, bhṛtya marma
Sundarānanda — Nityānanda's branch, servant intimate
yāṁra saṅge nityānanda kare vraja-narma
whom with Nityānanda enjoys the playful pastimes of Vraja

23 Sundarānanda, a branch of Nityānanda, was His intimate servant, and with him Nityānanda enjoyed the playful pastimes of Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.

Sundarānanda. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: “An ocean of the rasa of prema, named Sundarānanda, the chief among the associates of Nityānanda-svarūpa.” In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 127): “He who was formerly named Sudāma is now Ṭhākura Sundara.” He is one of the twelve *gopālas*, “Sudāma.”

His *śrīpāṭa* is the village of Maheśapura, 14 miles east of “Mājadiyā” station (formerly called “Śivanivāsa”) on the E.B.R. line; it is now in Yaśohara district. Nothing old remains here as a memorial except the site of Sundarānanda’s ancestral home. A Bāul lives at the *śrīpāṭa* on the edge of the village. The temple, the Deities and everything else are recent. At present Śrī Śrī Rādhā-vallabha and Śrī Śrī Rādhā-ramaṇa are served in Maheśapura. The river Vetravatī flows nearby. Sundarānanda Ṭhākura remained a celibate all his life, so he has no descendants. Descendants of his kinsmen and of his servitor-disciples are living. In the village of Maṅgaladihi in Vīrabhūma district there is a family of Sundarānanda’s kinsmen; Śrī Śrī Balarāma Jīu is served there. The Deity of Śrī Śrī Rādhā-vallabha established by Sundarānanda Ṭhākura was taken away by the Gosvāmīs of Saidābāda in Baharampura; later the present Deity was installed. Now the zamindars of Maheśapura are His servitors. On the full-moon day of Māgha the festival of Sundarānanda Ṭhākura’s disappearance is held.

(9) Kamalākara Pippalāi (gopāla 3) —

কমলাকর পিপ্পলাই — অলৌকিক রীত ।
অলৌকিক প্রেম তাঁর ভুবনে বিদিত ॥ ২৪ ॥

kamalākara pippalāi — alaukika rīta
Kamalākara Pippalāi — extraordinary ways
alaukika prema tāṁra bhuvane vidita
extraordinary love his in the world known

24 Kamalākara Pippalāi was extraordinary in his ways, and his extraordinary love is known throughout the world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The descendants of Kamalākara Pippalāi are servants of Śrī Jagannāthadeva at Māheśa.

Anubhāṣya.

Kamalākara Pippalāi. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 128): “He who was Mahābala came to be named Kamalākara Pippalāi.” He is one of the twelve *gopālas*, “Mahābala.” It was he who established the Deity of Śrī Jagannātha at Māheśa. The temple of Śrī Jagannāthadeva at Māheśa is about 2½ miles from Śrīrāmapura station on the E.I.R. line.

Kamalākara’s son was named Caturbhuja. Caturbhuja had two sons, Nārāyaṇa and Jagannātha; Nārāyaṇa’s son was Jagadānanda, and his son was Rājīvalocana. In his time the service of Jagannāthadeva fell short of funds. The Nawab of Ḍhākā, Oyālisa Sā (Sujā?), granted Jagannāthadeva 1185 *bighās* of land in the year 1060. The land lies in the village of Jagannāthapura, a *krośa* and a half west of Māheśa. That *mauzā* took the name “Jagannāthapura” from Jagannāthadeva’s name.

There is a tradition that Kamalākara’s younger brother, Nidhipati Pippalāi, searched for his elder brother, came to Māheśa, and found Kamalākara there. He could in no way persuade him to return home, so in the end he himself came to Māheśa with his own family and his brothers’ families and settled there. Even now about thirty households of twice-born descendants of Kamalākara Pippalāi live in the village of Māheśa, among them Śrīyukta Prasādadāsa Adhikārī.

Another story is told. A certain renunciant Vaiṣṇava named “Dhruvānanda” went to Puruṣottama-kṣetra. He strongly desired to cook with his own hands and offer *bhoga* to Śrī Jagannātha. At night he saw in a dream that Śrī Jagannāthadeva appeared to him and told him to go to the village of Māheśa on the bank of the Gaṅgā, install Śrī Jagannātha there, and fulfil his desire by offering Him *bhoga* every day with his own hands. When Dhruvānanda reached Māheśa, he saw Śrī Jagannātha, Balarāma and Subhadrā-devī floating in the waters of the Gaṅgā. He lifted the three Deities out of the water, built a hut on the bank of the Gaṅgā, and began to serve Them. As the time of his disappearance drew near, one thought filled his heart: who would be a fit servitor for Śrī Jagannātha? Then in a dream he received Śrī Jagannāthadeva’s order: “Tomorrow morning a resident of the village of Khālijuli near the Sundarbans, named ‘Śrī Kamalākara Pippalāi,’ a supreme devotee of Śrī Jagannāthadeva and a crest jewel of Vaiṣṇavas, will come to Māheśa; entrust the service to him.” The next morning Dhruvānanda met Kamalākara and entrusted him with the service of Śrī Jagannāthadeva. Ever since Kamalākara obtained the right to serve Śrī Jagannāthadeva, [his family] has borne the title “Adhikārī.” Among the fifty-six *grāmīs* (clans named after villages) of brāhmaṇas by birth of the Rāḍhīya class, “Pippalāi” is one.

(10) Sūryadāsa and (11) Kṛṣṇadāsa Sarakhela —

সূর্য্যদাস সরখেল, তাঁর ভাই কৃষ্ণদাস ।
নিত্যানন্দে দৃঢ় বিশ্বাস, প্রেমের নিবাস ॥ ২৫ ॥

sūryadāsa sarakhela, tāṁra bhāi kṛṣṇadāsa
Sūryadāsa Sarakhela, his brother Kṛṣṇadāsa
nityānande dṛḍha viśvāsa, premera nivāsa
in Nityānanda firm faith, of love the abode

25 Sūryadāsa Sarakhela and his brother Kṛṣṇadāsa had firm faith in Nityānanda and were abodes of love.

Anubhāṣya.

Sūryadāsa Sarakhela. *Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 12: "Not far from Navadvīpa is 'Śāligrāma.' There lives a paṇḍita named Sūryadāsa. He is very able in the service of the Yavana king in Gauḍa; he became famous as 'Sarakhela' and earned great wealth. Sūryadāsa is one of four brothers, all of very pure conduct. His two daughters are named Vasudhā and Jāhnavā." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 65): "His two beloveds, Vasudhā and Jāhnavī, descend from Śrī Vāruṇī and from the line of Revata.[4] They are the daughters of the great soul Śrī Sūryadāsa, who is Kakudmī, radiant as the sun."

Baḍagāchi. On the E.B.R. line, 2 miles from "Muḍāgāchā" station, lies Baḍagāchi, or Bahiragāchi, on the bank of the "Guḍaguḍe" canal, across from the village of Dharmadaha. Śāligrāma and Rukuṇapura are close by.

Kṛṣṇadāsa Sarakhela was the younger brother of Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita and Sūryadāsa Sarakhela. For the *adhivāsa* of Nityānanda's wedding he went from Baḍagāchi to Śāligrāma. *Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 12: "Taking various articles, Kṛṣṇadāsa Paṇḍita came from his home together with the brāhmaṇas."

(12) Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita (gopāla 4) —

শ্রীগৌরীদাস পণ্ডিতে প্রেমোদ্দণ্ডভক্তি ।
কৃষ্ণপ্রেমা দিতে, নিতে, ধরে মহাশক্তি ॥ ২৬ ॥

śrīgaurīdāsa paṇḍite premoddaṇḍa-bhakti
Śrī Gaurīdāsa in Paṇḍita devotion of soaring love
kṛṣṇa-premā dite, nite, dhare mahāśakti
love for Kṛṣṇa to give, to take, holds great power

26 Śrī Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita's devotion soared with prema; he had great power both to give and to receive love for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita. He was patronised by Rājā Kṛṣṇadāsa, the son of Hari Hoḍa. He is one of the twelve *gopālas* of Vraja, "Subala the friend." He lived first in Śāligrāma, not far from Muḍāgāchā station on the E.B.R. line, and later at Ambikā-Kālanā. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 128): "He who was Subala, the best of the dear friends, is Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita." *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita is supremely fortunate; in body, mind and words Nityānanda is his life." "Sarakhela Sūryadāsa Paṇḍita is generous. His brother Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita is renowned. Taking leave of his elder brother at Śāligrāma, he came to 'Ambikā' and made his home on the bank of the Gaṅgā."

He had twenty-two and a half branches: (1) Śrī Nṛsiṁha-caitanya, (2) Kṛṣṇadāsa, (3) Viṣṇudāsa, (4) Baḍa Balarāmadāsa, (5) Govinda, (6) Raghunātha, (7) Baḍu Gaṅgādāsa, (8) Āuliyā Gaṅgārāma, (9) Yādavācārya, (10) Hṛdaya-caitanya, (11) Cāða Hāladāra, (12) Maheśa Paṇḍita, (13) Mukuṭa Rāya, (14) Bhātuyā Gaṅgārāma, (15) Āuliyā Caitanya, (16) Kāliyā Kṛṣṇadāsa, (17) Pātuyā Gopāla, (18) Baḍa Jagannātha, (19) Nityānanda, (20) Bhāvi, (21) Jagadīśa, (22) Rāiyā Kṛṣṇadāsa, (22½) Annapūrṇā.

Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita's elder son was (Baḍa) Balarāma and the younger, Raghunātha. Raghunātha's sons were Maheśa Paṇḍita and Govinda, and his daughter was Annapūrṇā. Śrī Kaṁsāri Miśra of Śāligrāma (family title "Ghoṣāla," "Vātsya" *gotra*) had six sons: (1) Dāmodara, (2) Jagannātha, (3) Sūryadāsa Sarakhela (the father of Vasudhā and Jāhnavā), (4) Gaurīdāsa, (5) Kṛṣṇadāsa Sarakhela, (6) Nṛsiṁha-caitanya. Some descendants of Kaṁsāri Miśra's kinsmen still live in Śāligrāma. Neither Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita nor Hṛdaya-caitanya has descendants. Some say that those living now are descendants in the disciplic line of Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita or Hṛdaya-caitanya. When Jāhnavā-devī went to Śrī Vṛndāvana and saw the *samāja* of her uncle Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita, she wept: "Seeing the *samādhi* of Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita, she cannot stop the streams of tears flowing from her eyes." (*Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 11.)

Gaurīdāsa's disciple was Hṛdaya-caitanya; Hṛdaya-caitanya's disciple was Gopīramaṇa, the son of Annapūrṇā Devī. His descendants are the present *adhikārīs* of Mahāprabhu at Kālnā.

The *śrīpāṭa* of Ambikā-Kālnā is on the bank of the Gaṅgā across from Śāntipura, in Barddhamāna district; it is a subdivision and a small town. The *śrīpāṭa* is about 1 *krośa* east of Kālnā Court station on the Hāoḍā–Byāṇḍel–Bārahāroyā line, right next to the new *samāja-bāṭī* (mausoleum) of the Rājā of Barddhamāna, or the bazaar. At the entrance to Gaurīdāsa's temple stands a wonderful tamarind tree. It is said that Mahāprabhu and Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita met beneath this tamarind. The temple is paved with white stone, and in the three chambers of the building the sacred forms reside thus: (1) Śrī Gaurīdāsa, (2) Śrī Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, (3) Śrī Gaura-Nityānanda, (4) Śrī Jagannātha, (5) Śrī Balarāma and (6) Śrī Rāma-Sītā. West of Paṇḍita Gaurīdāsa's house is the temple of Śrī Sūryadāsa Paṇḍita, and a little farther away the *āśrama* of the perfected Śrī Bhagavān dāsa Bābājī.

The place where the present temple stands is called "Ambikā," and north of it is Kālnā; so together they are called "Ambikā-Kālnā." It is said that the oar Śrī Mahāprabhu plied with His own hand and the *Gītā* written in His own hand (see the *Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 7) are still kept in the temple.

Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita, whose life is Gaura and Nitāi —

নিত্যানন্দে সমর্পিল জাতি-কুল-পাঁতি ।
শ্রীচৈতন্য-নিত্যানন্দে করি' প্রাণপতি ॥ ২৭ ॥

nityānande samarpila jāti-kula-pāṁti
to Nityānanda surrendered caste family place at the common meal
śrī-caitanya-nityānande kari' prāṇapati
Śrī Caitanya-Nityānanda making the Lords of his life

27 Gaurīdāsa surrendered to Nityānanda his caste, his family and his place in his community, and made Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda the Lords of his life.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"*Pāṁti*": eating together in one row (*paṅkti-bhojana*).

Thus ends the eleventh chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

(13) Purandara Paṇḍita —

নিত্যানন্দ প্রভুর প্রিয় — পণ্ডিত পুরন্দর ।
প্রেমার্ণব-মধ্যে ফিরে যৈছন মন্দর ॥ ২৮ ॥

nityānanda prabhura priya — paṇḍita purandara
of Nityānanda Prabhu dear — Paṇḍita Purandara
premārṇava-madhye phire yaichana mandara
the ocean of love within moves like Mandara

28 Purandara Paṇḍita was dear to Nityānanda Prabhu; he moved through the ocean of love like Mount Mandara.

Anubhāṣya.

Purandara Paṇḍita. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Purandara Paṇḍita is supremely peaceful and self-controlled; he is exclusively dear to Nityānanda-svarūpa." Antya, Chapter 5: "Then the Prabhu came to the village of Khaḍadaha, to the place of Purandara Paṇḍita's temple. No one can describe all the dancing that Prabhu Nityānanda Rāya did in the village of Khaḍadaha. Purandara Paṇḍita was in supreme madness: climbing a tree, he roared like a lion. Crying, 'I am Aṅgada!' he leaped down."

(14) Parameśvarī dāsa (gopāla 5) —

পরমেশ্বরদাস — নিত্যানন্দৈক-শরণ ।
কৃষ্ণভক্তি পায়, তাঁরে যে করে স্মরণ ॥ ২৯ ॥

parameśvara-dāsa — nityānandaika-śaraṇa
Parameśvara dāsa — Nityānanda his sole shelter
kṛṣṇa-bhakti pāya, tāṁre ye kare smaraṇa
devotion to Kṛṣṇa attains, him who does remember

29 Parameśvara dāsa took shelter in Nityānanda alone; whoever remembers him attains devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Parameśvara, or Parameśvarī dāsa. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Parameśvara dāsa, whose life is Nityānanda; in his body Nityānanda sports." Antya, Chapter 5: "Kṛṣṇadāsa and Parameśvara dāsa — these two, in the mood of

cowherd boys, shout ‘He! He!’ all the time. Purandara Paṇḍita and Parameśvarī dāsa, in whose body Gauracandra is manifest, came running at once. Seeing the Prabhu, both wept, overcome with love.” For some time he lived in Khaḍadaha. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 132): “He who was formerly the friend named Arjuna is the servant Śrī Parameśvara.” He is one of the twelve *gopālas*, the friend “Arjuna.” When the queen Śrī Jāhnavā went to the festival at Kheturi, Parameśvara was with her (*Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 10). By the order of Mother Jāhnavā he installed the Deity “Śrī Rādhā-Gopīnātha” at Āṭapura (see the same, wave 13).

In the *Śrī Vaiṣṇava-vandanā*: “With care I shall honour Parameśvara dāsa Ṭhākura, who made a jackal utter the holy name where saṅkīrtana was held.” The thirteenth wave of the *Bhakti-ratnākara* tells of Parameśvarī Ṭhākura.

The *śrīpāṭa* of Parameśvarī Ṭhākura is Āṭapura, on the Cāṗāḍāṅgā branch of the Hāoḍā–Āmtā railway, near Āṭapura station and the ancient temple of Śrī Rādhā-Govinda, founded by the late Kṛṣṇakumāra Mitra, *dewan* of the Barddhamāna Rāja Teja Bāhādura. Formerly the place was called “Viśakhālā.”

Right in front of the temple grow two *bakula* trees side by side, giving dense shade, and separately a kadamba tree; between them is the *samādhi* of Parameśvarī Ṭhākura, beautifully crowned with a tulasī platform. It is said that the present two trees grew from branches of the two *bakula* trees that stood in Śrīla Parameśvarī Ṭhākura’s time. Every year the kadamba tree bears a single flower, and with it the Deity’s lotus feet are worshipped.

Parameśvarī Ṭhākura was born in a Vaidya family. His brother’s descendants are the present servitors of the *śrīpāṭa*. Some of them also live in the village of Garalagāchā (Caṇḍītalā post office, Hugalī district). Until recently they had many disciples who were brāhmaṇas by birth. But in the course of time they took up the Vaidya profession, like ordinary worldly people, and so all their disciples of brāhmaṇa families gradually left them. Their title is “Adhikārī.” The present servitors of the *śrīpāṭa* are Śrī Rādhikāprasanna Adhikārī Kavirāja Mahāśaya and the widowed, sonless mother-in-law of Naṭavara Adhikārī Mahāśaya. The family name of their caste is “Gupta.”

They regard themselves as ordinary “Vaidyas” and have the Ṭhākura worshipped by *devala brāhmaṇas*. There are now eight households of servitors, and the eight households have merged into two. Formerly much land was set aside for the Deity’s service, but they have lost all of it. Now the service of the Deity is kept up with great difficulty on a small *debottara* endowment.

In the temple, Śrī Baladeva and Śrī Rādhā-Gopīnātha are seen on a single throne. The Baladeva Deity was probably installed later. To place Śrī Baladeva and Śrī Kṛṣṇa with Śrīmatī on the same throne is contrary to *tattva*. On the full-moon day of Vaiśākha the festival of Parameśvarī Ṭhākura's disappearance is held.

(15) Jagadīśa Paṇḍita —

শ্রীজগদীশ পণ্ডিত হয় জগৎ-পাবন ।
কৃষ্ণপ্রেমামৃত বর্ষে, যেন বর্ষা ঘন ॥ ৩০ ॥

śrī jagadīśa paṇḍita haya jagat-pāvana
Śrī Jagadīśa Paṇḍita is of the world the purifier
kṛṣṇa-premāmṛta varṣe, yena varṣā ghana
the nectar of love for Kṛṣṇa rains, like rain heavy

30 Śrī Jagadīśa Paṇḍita purifies the whole world; like a heavy monsoon rain, he pours down the nectar of love for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

The *śrīpāṭa* of Śrī Jagadīśa Paṇḍita is the village of Yaśaḍā, within a mile of Cākadaha station (on the E.B.R. line) in Nadīyā district. See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 4, and the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Ādi 14.39. From the account of the Yaśaḍā *śrīpāṭa* we learn that Jagadīśa Bhaṭṭa was born in East Bengal, in the region of Gauhāṭī. His father, Kamalākṣa, was a descendant of Bhaṭṭanārāyaṇa, of the Bandyaghaṭīya family of Gayaghara. Both Jagadīśa's father and his mother were householders devoted to Viṣṇu. After his parents' disappearance, Jagadīśa left his birthplace with his wife "Duḥkhinī" and his brother Maheśa. In order to live on the bank of the Gaṅgā and spend his time with Vaiṣṇavas, he came to Śrī Māyāpura and settled near the house of Śrī Jagannātha Miśra. Gaurasundara ordered Jagadīśa to go to Nīlācala to preach the holy name. By Śrīman Mahāprabhu's order Jagadīśa Paṇḍita preached the name in Nīlācala. There he prayed to Jagannāthadeva, and in answer to his prayer he was allowed to bring back a form of Jagannāthadeva. Jagadīśa installed the Deity in the village of Yaśaḍā on the bank of the Gaṅgā, now within Cākadaha police station. There is a tradition that Jagadīśa Paṇḍita carried this Jagannātha Deity from Puruṣottama to Yaśaḍā on a staff. Even today the servitors at Yaśaḍā display a staff as "Jagadīśa Paṇḍita's staff on which the Jagannātha Deity was brought."

It is said that Śrī Gaura-Nityānanda Prabhu came to the village of Yaśaḍā twice with Their associates, and here there were saṅkīrtana processions, talks about Hari, kīrtana and a great festival.

Jagadīśa Paṇḍita enacted the pastime of a householder. His only son was named "Rāmabhadra Gosvāmī."

Formerly the Jagannātha Deity was installed under a banyan tree on the bank of the Gaṅgā; later Rājā Kṛṣṇacandra of Goyāḍī-Kṛṣṇanagara had a temple built. When the temple built by the Rājā of Kṛṣṇanagara fell into ruin, Mokṣadā Dāsī, the wife of the local Umeśacandra Majumadāra, in 1324 restored the present temple; this is inscribed on a stone plaque. The temple has no spire and looks like an ordinary house. In front of it is a modest courtyard. In the temple reside Śrī Jagannāthadeva, Śrī Rādhā-vallabha Jīu and the Gaura-Gopāla installed by Jagadīśa's wife, Mother Duḥkhinī.

When Mahāprabhu had sanctified Jagadīśa's house in Yaśaḍā and was about to leave for Nīlācala, Duḥkhinī was deeply grieved at the separation from Gaurasundara. So Mahāprabhu agreed to accept Duḥkhinī's service in the village of Yaśaḍā in the form of the Gaura-Gopāla Deity. Ever since, the Śrī Gaura-Gopāla Deity (a golden-hued wooden form of Gopāla) has been served there.

The Gaṅgā has moved away from this place by nearly a *krośa*. For some time the perfected Bhagavān dāsa Bābājī Mahāśaya of Kālnā performed *bhajana* in the village of Yaśaḍā. Later the Bābājī Mahāśaya left this place and settled in Kālnā, but even from Kālnā he came here from time to time. At that time Vijayacandra Gosvāmī Mahāśaya was the servitor of Śrī Jagannāthadeva. The present servitor of the *śrīpāṭa* is Śrī Lalitamohana Gosvāmī. The family are Bāḍuyyes (Bandyopādhyāyas); their maternal uncles are of the Gāṅgulī family. A *sūcaka-gāna* (introductory song) on Jagadīśa Paṇḍita Gosvāmī, composed by a Vaiṣṇava poet named Gadādhara, is still sung in the village of Yaśaḍā. The song sets out the life of Jagadīśa Paṇḍita in a few words. Raghunāthācārya, the son of Khañja Bhagavān, was a disciple of Jagadīśa Paṇḍita Gosvāmī.

Jagadīśa Paṇḍita's disappearance day is the third lunar day of the bright fortnight of Pauṣa. Every year on the twelfth lunar day of the bright fortnight of Pauṣa the festival of Jagadīśa Paṇḍita's birth is held, and many people gather for the Snāna-yātrā.

(16) Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita (gopāla 6) —

নিত্যানন্দ-প্রিয়ভৃত্য পণ্ডিত ধনঞ্জয় ।
অত্যন্ত বিরক্ত, সদা কৃষ্ণপ্রেমময় ॥ ৩১ ॥

nityānanda-priya-bhṛtya paṇḍita dhanañjaya
of Nityānanda dear servant Paṇḍita Dhanañjaya
atyanta virakta, sadā kṛṣṇa-premamaya
extremely detached, always full of love for Kṛṣṇa

31 Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita, a dear servant of Nityānanda, was utterly detached and always full of love for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita lived in the village of Śītala near Kāṭoyā. He is one of the twelve *gopālas*, the friend "Vasudāma." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 127): "The friend Vasudāma is Paṇḍita Śrī Dhanañjaya." *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita is an extraordinary *mahānta*; Nityānanda is in his heart every moment."

Śītalagrāma lies in Barddhamāna district, within Maṅgalakoṭa police station and Kaicara post office. From Barddhamāna one takes the Kāṭoyā light railway, gets off at Kaicara station, 9 miles from Kāṭoyā, and goes 1 mile to the northeast. The temple is a thatched hut with a mud wall around it. Long ago the Mallika Bābus of the village of "Bājārabana Kābāśī" built a brick house for the Deity. That temple collapsed sixty-four or sixty-five years ago; the foundation of the old temple still remains. To the left of the entrance is a tulasī altar: this is the *samādhi* altar of Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita. In the west-facing house are Śrī Gopīnātha, whom Śrī Dhanañjaya served, Śrī Śrī Nitāi-Gaura, and the Deity of Śrī Dāmodara. Every year in the middle of the month of Māgha the Deities are carried to a garden a little way from the temple, and the disappearance festival is held. Some say that Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita's real birthplace is the village of "Jāḍ" in Caṭṭagrāma district. He came from there and established Deity service in Śītalagrāma and in the village of Sāčaḍā-Pāčaḍā.

It is said that he performed saṅkīrtana with Mahāprabhu in Navadvīpa for some time, returned to Śītalagrāma, and from there set out to see Śrī Vṛndāvana-dhāma. On the way to Vṛndāvana he stayed for a while in the village of Sāčaḍā-Pāčaḍā, three *krośas* south of present-day Memārī station. There he permitted the disciple

travelling with him to establish the service of the Deity, and he himself went on to Vṛndāvana. That is why people also call the village of Sāčaḍā-Pāčaḍā "Dhanañjaya's *pāṭa*." Now this village holds no trace of Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita; his principal *śrīpāṭa* is Śītalagrāma itself. On returning from Vṛndāvana he served the Deity in the village of Jalandi, and from there he came again to Śītalagrāma and established the service of Śrī Gaurāṅgadeva.

It is said that Dhanañjaya had no descendants. He had a brother named Sañjaya, whose son was named Rāmakānāi Ṭhākura. Sañjaya's *śrīpāṭa* is the village of Jalandi (Lokanagara post office) in Barddhamāna district, four or five *krośas* to the east. Among Sañjaya's descendants, Śrī Nīlamaṇi Ṭhākura, Śrī Rākhālacandra Ṭhākura and others, as well as descendants through a daughter, Śrī Kānāilāla Mukhopādhyāya and others, live in Jalandi itself. Śrī Rādhā-Govinda is served there. The *śrīpāṭa* of that Rāmakānāi is in Mulukagrāma, very close to present-day Bolapura; the servitors, Śrī Yugalakiśora Mukhopādhyāya and Śrī Gaurakiśora Mukhopādhyāya, live there. Some say that Sañjaya was Dhanañjaya's disciple. The present servitors at Śītalagrāma are descendants of a disciple of Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita. The ancient Deity Śrī Śyāmasundara Jīu, installed by Dhanañjaya's disciple Jīvanakṛṣṇa, is now in the house of Gopāla Rāya Caudhurī.

(17) Maheśa Paṇḍita (gopāla 7) —

মহেশ পণ্ডিত — ব্রজের উদার গোপাল ।
ঢক্কাবাদ্যে নৃত্য করে প্রেমে মাতোয়াল ॥ ৩২ ॥

maheśa paṇḍita — vrajera udāra gopāla
Maheśa Paṇḍita — of Vraja the generous cowherd boy
ḍhakkā-vādye nṛtya kare preme mātoyāla
to the kettledrum dance does in love intoxicated

32 Maheśa Paṇḍita is a generous cowherd boy of Vraja; to the beat of the kettledrum he would dance, drunk with love.

Anubhāṣya.

Maheśa Paṇḍita. His *śrīpāṭa* was at Pālapāḍā until the first few months of the Bengali year 1334. It was then moved to the village of Kāṭhāladhuli near Cākadaha. He is one of the twelve *gopālas,* the friend "Mahābāhu." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 129): "Maheśa Paṇḍita is the glorious Mahābāhu, a friend in

Vraja." *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Maheśa Paṇḍita is a most exalted *mahānta*."

Pālapāḍā lies in Nadīyā district, in the jungle, a mile south of Cākadaha station on the E.B.R. line. The Gaṅgā is far from here. Formerly Maheśa Paṇḍita lived across from Jirāṭ, on the eastern bank, at a place called Masipura or Yaśīpura (?). But Masīpura was swallowed by the Gaṅgā, and the Deity installed by Maheśa Paṇḍita stayed for some time at Beleḍāṅgā near Sukhasāgara. When the Gaṅgā eroded and destroyed Beleḍāṅgā as well, the zamindar of Pālapāḍā, Navakumāra Caṭṭopādhyāya, prevailed on the servitor of that time, Bābājī Rāmakṛṣṇadāsa, to bring the Deity to Pālapāḍā, and he built a temple there. Navakumāra Bābu's son, Rajanī Bābu, registered the temple lands in the name of Harekṛṣṇadāsa Bābājī in 1883 A.D. Since then the name "Pālapāḍā-pāṭa" has continued. Pālapāḍā is in Pāčanagara *parganā*. Fourteen *mauzās* — Beleḍāṅgā, Berigrāma, Sukhasāgara, Cānduḍe, Manasāpotā, Pālapāḍā and others — lie in Pāčanagara, so some call the area "Nāgaradeśa." Some hold that this Maheśa Paṇḍita was the younger brother of Jagadīśa Paṇḍita of the Yaśaḍā *śrīpāṭa*. They say that Jagadīśa, Hiraṇya and this Maheśa Paṇḍita were three brothers: Jagadīśa the eldest, Hiraṇya the middle, and Maheśa the youngest. But authoritative books do not say whether this Maheśa Paṇḍita was Śrī Jagadīśa's brother, so the claim is doubtful.

Śrī Maheśa Paṇḍita was with Śrī Nityānanda at the festival at Pāṇihāṭi, and after the festival he went with Śrī Nityānanda to Saptagrāma. The eighth wave of the *Bhakti-ratnākara* shows that when Śrī Narottama Ṭhākura came to Khaḍadaha, Śrī Maheśa Paṇḍita was present there.

The temple of the *śrīpāṭa* is a simple house. In the dilapidated temple reside the sacred forms of Śrī Gaura-Nityānanda, Śrī Gopīnātha, Śrī Madana-mohana, Śrī Rādhā-Govinda and a *śālagrāma*. In front of the temple is the altar of Maheśa Paṇḍita's *phula-samāja* (flower tomb). Now the service is maintained only by begging. A local resident, Śrī Kālīkṛṣṇa Cakravartī, contributes 25 rupees a year. Śrī Maheśa Paṇḍita has no descendants. The present servitor is Śrī Sanātana dāsa Bābājī.

(18) Puruṣottama Paṇḍita (gopāla 8) —

নবদ্বীপে পুরুষোত্তম পণ্ডিত মহাশয় ।
নিত্যানন্দ-নামে যাঁর মহোন্মাদ হয় ॥ ৩৩ ॥

navadvīpe puruṣottama paṇḍita mahāśaya
in Navadvīpa Puruṣottama Paṇḍita a great soul
nityānanda-nāme yāṁra mahonmāda haya
at Nityānanda's name whose great madness comes

33 Puruṣottama Paṇḍita of Navadvīpa was a great soul; at the very name of Nityānanda he was seized by the great madness of love.

Anubhāṣya.
Puruṣottama Paṇḍita. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Paṇḍita Puruṣottama was born in Navadvīpa; he is a great servant of Nityānanda-svarūpa, close to His heart." He is one of the twelve *gopālas*, "Stokakṛṣṇa." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 130): "He who was formerly the friend Stokakṛṣṇa is the servant Śrī Puruṣottama." Some say that his *śrīpāṭa* is at Sukhasāgara.

(19) Balarāma dāsa —

বলরাম দাস — কৃষ্ণপ্রেমরসাস্বাদী ।
নিত্যানন্দ-নামে হয় পরম উন্মাদী ॥ ৩৪ ॥

balarāma dāsa — kṛṣṇa-prema-rasāsvādī
Balarāma dāsa — the rasa of love for Kṛṣṇa tasting
nityānanda-nāme haya parama unmādī
at Nityānanda's name becomes supremely mad

34 Balarāma dāsa tasted the rasa of love for Kṛṣṇa, and at the name of Nityānanda he was utterly beside himself.

Anubhāṣya.
Balarāma dāsa. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Balarāma dāsa, utterly intoxicated with the rasa of prema: even by the breeze that has touched him, all sins are destroyed."

(20) Yadunātha Kavicandra —

মহাভাগবত যদুনাথ কবিচন্দ্র ।
যাঁহার হৃদয়ে নৃত্য করে নিত্যানন্দ ॥ ৩৫ ॥

mahā-bhāgavata yadunātha kavicandra
the great devotee Yadunātha Kavicandra
yāṁhāra hṛdaye nṛtya kare nityānanda
whose in the heart dance does Nityānanda

35 Yadunātha Kavicandra was a great devotee, in whose heart Nityānanda dances.

Anubhāṣya.
Yadunātha Kavicandra. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Yadunātha Kavicandra is full of the rasa of prema; Nityānanda is always in his heart." The same work, Madhya, Chapter 1: "Ratnagarbha Ācārya is his famous name; he was a companion of Nityānanda Prabhu's father,[5] born in the same village. His three sons are like the honey of Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet: Kṛṣṇānanda, Jīva and Yadunātha Kavicandra."

(21) Dvija Kṛṣṇadāsa —

রাঢ়ে যাঁর জন্ম কৃষ্ণদাস দ্বিজবর ।
শ্রীনিত্যানন্দের তিঁহো পরম কিঙ্কর ॥ ৩৬ ॥

rāḍhe yāṁra janma kṛṣṇadāsa dvija-vara
in Rāḍha whose birth Kṛṣṇadāsa the best of brāhmaṇas
śrī-nityānandera tiṁho parama kiṅkara
of Śrī Nityānanda he the foremost servant

36 Kṛṣṇadāsa, an excellent brāhmaṇa born in Rāḍha, was a foremost servant of Śrī Nityānanda.

Anubhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇadāsa. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "The noble brāhmaṇa Kṛṣṇadāsa was born in Rāḍha; his pastimes are among Nityānanda's associates."

(22) Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa (gopāla 9) —

কালা-কৃষ্ণদাস বড় বৈষ্ণবপ্রধান ।
নিত্যানন্দ-চন্দ্র বিনা নাহি জানে আন ॥ ৩৭ ॥

kālā-kṛṣṇadāsa baḍa vaiṣṇava-pradhāna
Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa great among Vaiṣṇavas foremost
nityānanda-candra vinā nāhi jāne āna
Nityānanda the moon but not knows another

37 Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa was a great Vaiṣṇava, among the foremost; he knew no one but the moonlike Nityānanda.

Anubhāṣya.

Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Kāliyā Kṛṣṇadāsa is famous throughout the three worlds; by remembering him one attains Gauracandra." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 132): "He who is Lavaṅga, the friend in Vraja, is Kāla Śrī Kṛṣṇadāsa." He is one of the twelve *gopālas*, the friend "Lavaṅga." His *śrīpāṭa* is the village of "Ākāihāṭ" in Barddhamāna district, within Kāṭoyā police station and post office; it lies beside the "Navadvīpa–Kāṭoyā" highway that runs from Kāṭoyā. On the E.I.R. line one goes from Byāṇḍel junction to Kāṭoyā station and walks two miles from there; or one gets off at Dāĩhāṭ, the station before Kāṭoyā, and the way is about a mile. The village of Ākāihāṭ is very small, and few people live there. The *śrīpāṭa* is now in decay. The temple over Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura's *samādhi* has collapsed: its beams broke and everything lies buried. Going from the road through a mango grove, one sees ahead a ruined little room. In it is the Deity's empty altar, and in its southeast corner a thatched shed, under which is the *samāja* of the servitors. The present servitor is Hareramadāsa Bābājī. To the south is a pond: this is "Nūpura-kuṇḍa." Tradition says that the anklet (*nūpura*) of Raghunandana Ṭhākura, the son of Mukunda of Śrīkhaṇḍa — or, as some say, of Nityānanda Prabhu — fell into this pond. It is said that this anklet, along with Śrī Rādhā-vallabha and Śrī Gopāla Jīu of the Ākāihāṭ *śrīpāṭa*, is still kept at the *mahānta-bāṭī* in the village of Kaḍui, three *krośas* from Ākāihāṭ. There is a handwritten *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata* of the year 1200 and a *Śrī Caritāmṛta* copied in 1271. In the month of Caitra, on the twelfth lunar day of the dark fortnight — the day of Vāruṇī — the festival of Śrī Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura's disappearance is held here.

According to the "Gosvāmīs" of the village of "Sonātalā," on the north bank of the river Ichāmatī about 3 miles west of the well-known Beḍābandara in Pābanā district, Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura was born in a brāhmaṇa family of the Varendra class, of the Bharadvāja *gotra*, and a "Bhāduḍa-grāmī." From Ākāihāṭ, Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura, preaching the holy name, came to Pābanā. In the field where

he set up his *āśrama*, ruins of buildings can still be seen. Later his kinsmen also came to this place. As there were no Vārendra brāhmaṇas at Ākāihāṭ, he married in this region, and after some time he went again to Ākāihāṭ and to Śrī Vṛndāvana. While he was living in the village of Sonātalā, a son named "Śrī Mohanadāsa" was born to him. He left the boy at the home of his maternal uncle in the village of Sonātalā, or Bhāduṭī-Mathurāpura, gave him all his property, and went with his wife to Śrī Vṛndāvana. In Śrī Vṛndāvana another son was born to him, named "Gaurāṅgadāsa." Because Gaurāṅgadāsa was born in Śrī Vṛndāvana, he was also called Vṛndāvanadāsa. Later the father sent him too to his eldest son, Mohanadāsa, and told him to take a six-*ānā* share (six-sixteenths) of the property. Gaurāṅgadāsa manifested the Deity of Śrī Kālācāṅda, resembling Śrī Govinda Jīu of Śrī Vṛndāvana, and served Him together with his elder brother.

Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura's descendants, headed by Śrī Vijayagovinda Gosvāmī, still live today in Sonātalā and other places in Pābanā district.

At Sonātalā one can still see the site of the *āśrama* house, the bricks of the temple, and the *ghāṭa* of the pond. The Deity here, Śrī Kālācāṅda Jīu, is served in turn by Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa's descendants themselves. Here, in the month of Agrahāyaṇa, on the twelfth lunar day of the dark fortnight, the festival of Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura's disappearance is held.

(23) Sadāśiva Kavirāja, (24) Puruṣottama (gopāla 10) —

শ্রীসদাশিব কবিরাজ — বড় মহাশয় ।
শ্রীপুরুষোত্তমদাস — তাঁহার তনয় ॥ ৩৮ ॥

śrī-sadāśiva kavirāja — baḍa mahāśaya
Śrī Sadāśiva Kavirāja — great soul
śrī-puruṣottama-dāsa — tāṁhāra tanaya
Śrī Puruṣottama dāsa — his son

38 Śrī Sadāśiva Kavirāja was a great soul, and Śrī Puruṣottama dāsa was his son.

“Nāgara” Puruṣottama —

আজন্ম নিমগ্ন নিত্যানন্দের চরণে ।
নিরন্তর বাল্য-লীলা করে কৃষ্ণ-সনে ॥ ৩৯ ॥

ājanma nimagna nityānandera caraṇe
from birth immersed in Nityānanda’s feet
nirantara bālya-līlā kare kṛṣṇa-sane
constantly childhood pastimes does Kṛṣṇa with

39 From his birth he was absorbed in the feet of Nityānanda, and he ceaselessly played childhood games with Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Sadāśiva Kavirāja and Nāgara Puruṣottama. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: “Sadāśiva Kavirāja is greatly fortunate; his son is named Śrī Puruṣottama dāsa. Puruṣottama dāsa’s body has no external consciousness: Nityānanda-candra sports in his heart.” In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 156): “She who was formerly Candrāvalī in Vraja, most dear to Kṛṣṇa, is now in Gauḍa the Kavirāja Sadāśiva.” Verse 131: “Sadāśiva’s son, named Nāgara Puruṣottama, born in a Vaidya family, is he who in Vraja was the cowherd named Dāma.” Sadāśiva Kavirāja’s father, Kaṁsāri Sena, is in Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes the sakhī “Ratnāvalī” of Vraja. Some say that Kaṁsāri Sena lived at Guptipāḍā on the E.I.R. line, but no trace of him can be found there now. Be that as it may, perfected devotees of Gaura like these, four generations in a row, are rare anywhere else.

Śrī Puruṣottama Ṭhākura’s *śrīpāṭa* was formerly at Sukhasāgara, equidistant from Cākadaha and Śimurāli stations. First, when the village of Beleḍāṅgā was destroyed, Śrī Puruṣottama Ṭhākura’s Deities were brought to Sukhasāgara. Then Sukhasāgara too was swallowed by the Gaṅgā. So Puruṣottama Ṭhākura’s Deity was brought to Sāhebaḍāṅgā-Beḍigrāma together with the Deities of Mother Śrī Jāhnavā’s *gādi* (seat), which had been at that place. When Beḍigrāma too was destroyed, Puruṣottama Ṭhākura’s Deity, together with the Deities of Mother Jāhnavā’s *gādi*, was moved to the village of Cāñduḍe, where He has now resided for about fifty years.

The village of Cāñduḍe on the Bhāgīrathī is in Nadīyā district, within Cākadaha police station, a mile from “Simurāli” station on the E.B.R. line and a mile’s walk from “Pālapāḍā.”

Since the old Sukhasāgara was swallowed by the river, the new Sukhasāgara lies 3–4 miles from the village of Cāñduḍe, south of Kālīgañja.

Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu's son-in-law, the husband of Śrīmatī Gaṅgā-devī, was Śrī Mādhavācārya (Mādhava Caṭṭopādhyāya) of Jirāṭ; according to some he was a disciple of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, according to others of Śrī Jāhnavā-devī, and according to others of this Śrī Puruṣottama Ṭhākura. The *Vaiṣṇava-vandanā* states plainly that its author, Śrī Devakīnandana dāsa, was a disciple of this very Puruṣottama.

The present temple is a thatched hut with a mud wall. In the temple reside Śrī Jagannātha, Balarāma and Subhadrā; Nitāi-Gaura, two pairs of Deities; Gopīnātha; Mother Jāhnavā; Bāla-Gopāla; Rādhā-Govinda, five pairs; Revatī and Balarāma; and a *śālagrāma*. Some say that several of these sacred forms were installed by Puruṣottama Ṭhākura and the rest belong to Jāhnavā-devī's *gādi*. This *śrīpāṭa* is also known as "the *pāṭa* of Vasu-Jāhnavā." The names of the following servitor-*mahāntas* of the Cāñduḍe *śrīpāṭa* are known: (1) Gopāladāsa Mahānta, (2) Rāmakṛṣṇa, (3) Vihāridāsa, (4) Rāmadāsa, (5) Gopāladāsa and (6) the present aged servitor, Sītānātha dāsa.

(25) Kānu Ṭhākura —

তাঁর পুত্র — মহাশয় শ্রীকানু ঠাকুর ।
যাঁর দেহে রহে কৃষ্ণ-প্রেমামৃতপূর ॥ ৪০ ॥

tāṁra putra — mahāśaya śrī-kānu ṭhākura
his son — the great soul Śrī Kānu Ṭhākura
yāṁra dehe rahe kṛṣṇa-premāmṛta-pūra
whose in the body dwells of the nectar of love for Kṛṣṇa a flood

40 His son was the great soul Śrī Kānu Ṭhākura, whose body overflowed with the nectar of love for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Kānu Ṭhākura. Some count him among the twelve *gopālas*. He lived at Bodhakhānā. On the Central Section of the E.B.R. line one gets off at "Jhikaragāchā-ghāṭ" station, and from there, by boat on the river Kapotākṣa or overland, it is 2 or 2½ miles to the *śrīpāṭa* of Bodhakhānā.

Ṭhākura Kānāi's ancestor four generations back, Śrī Kaṁsāri Sena, was also called "Sambarāri." In the *Vaiṣṇava-vandanā* Devakīnandana names four generations of Ṭhākura Kānāi's ancestors: "I honour Śrī Kaṁsāri Sena and Sena Śrīvallabha. With all my heart I honour Sadāśiva Kavirāja, who is ever mad with love and knows nothing external. I honour my chosen lord, named Śrī Puruṣottama. Who can describe his incomparable qualities?"

Puruṣottama Ṭhākura was the son of Sadāśiva, and Kānu Ṭhākura was the son of Puruṣottama Ṭhākura. Kānu Ṭhākura's descendants hold that Puruṣottama Ṭhākura and "Nāgara Puruṣottama" were different persons. They say that Kānu Ṭhākura's father is the one mentioned in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* as "Dāsa Puruṣottama," who is "Stokakṛṣṇa" in the pastimes of Vraja. But in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* it is Puruṣottama, the son of Sadāśiva, born in a Vaidya family, who is called "Nāgara Puruṣottama." This Nāgara Puruṣottama is the friend named "Dāma" in the pastimes of Vraja. Among Kānu Ṭhākura's descendants a tradition is current that Puruṣottama Ṭhākura lived in the village of "Sukhasāgara" on the east bank of the Gaṅgā. Puruṣottama's wife was named "Jāhnavā." Soon after Ṭhākura Kānāi's birth, Jāhnavā disappeared from this world. When Nityānanda Prabhu learned that Puruṣottama Ṭhākura had lost his wife, He came to Puruṣottama's house and took the twelve-year-old[6] child to His own home at Khaḍadaha.

According to Kānu Ṭhākura's descendants, Ṭhākura Kānāi appeared in Śaka 1457 (Bengali year 942), on the second lunar day of the bright fortnight of Āṣāḍha, a Thursday, the day of the Ratha-yātrā. Seeing the Ṭhākura's devotion to Kṛṣṇa from infancy, Nityānanda Prabhu named him "Śiśu Kṛṣṇadāsa" (the child Kṛṣṇadāsa).

In his fifth year the child Kṛṣṇadāsa went with the queen Mother Jāhnavā to Śrī Vṛndāvana-dhāma. The Vrajavāsīs headed by Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī, seeing the child Kṛṣṇadāsa's *bhāva* and other signs, gave him the name "Ṭhākura Kānāi." There is a story that once in Vṛndāvana, as Ṭhākura Kānāi danced, overwhelmed by the bliss of kīrtana, an anklet vanished from his right foot. Ṭhākura Kānāi then said, "Wherever this anklet has fallen, there I will live." It is said that the anklet fell in a village called "Bodhakhānā" in Yaśohara district, and from then on Ṭhākura Kānāi came to live at Bodhakhānā.

Another tradition is handed down in this family: the Deity "Prāṇavallabha" has been served since some ancestor of Sadāśiva several hundred years before the appearance of Śrīman Mahāprabhu. This "Prāṇavallabha" is still served at Bodhakhānā.

At the time of the "Bargī hāṅgāmā" (the Bargī raids), all of Ṭhākura Kānāi's sons, headed by Vaṁśīvadana, except the descendants of his eldest son, fled Bodhakhānā and settled in a village called "Bhājana-ghāṭ" in Nadīyā district. One of the descendants of Ṭhākura Kānāi's younger sons, named "Harikṛṣṇa Gosvāmī," came back to Bodhakhānā after the Bargī raids had ended. He installed another, new Deity, also named "Prāṇavallabha." Even now, in the village of Bodhakhānā, the descendants of Ṭhākura Kānāi's eldest son serve the ancient "Śrī Prāṇavallabha," and the descendants of the younger son serve the newly installed "Prāṇavallabha." At Bhājana-ghāṭ the Deity "Śrī Rādhā-vallabha" is served. The book *Prema-vilāsa* shows that Kānu Ṭhākura was present at the Kheturi festival together with Jāhnavā-devī and Vīrabhadra Prabhu.

Puruṣottama Ṭhākura and Kānu Ṭhākura had many disciples who were brāhmaṇas by birth. The four chief disciples of Puruṣottama Ṭhākura who were brāhmaṇas by birth are named thus: "His four dearest disciples, the best of brāhmaṇas: first Mādhavācārya, then Yādavācārya Paṇḍita, and Daivakīnandana dāsa, famous in Gauḍa-maṇḍala, who composed the book *Śrīmad Vaiṣṇava-vandanā*." This Mādhavācārya is the husband of Gaṅgā-devī, the daughter of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. After the village of Sukhasāgara was destroyed, the Deities installed by Puruṣottama were brought to Cānduḍiyā, and they are now served together with his other Deities under the supervision of the descendants of Gaṅgā at Jirāṭ. Puruṣottama Ṭhākura's *śrīpāṭa* is also called the *pāṭa* of "Vasu-Jāhnavā."

Kānu Ṭhākura's disciples live in the village of Gaḍabetā on the bank of the river Śilāvatī in Medinīpura district. A brāhmaṇa named "Śrīrāma," of the Rāḍhī class and of the Kauthumī branch of the *Sāma Veda*, was a famous disciple of Kānāi Ṭhākura.

(26) Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura (gopāla 11) —

মহাভাগবত-শ্রেষ্ঠ দত্ত উদ্ধারণ ।
সর্ব্বভাবে সেবে নিত্যানন্দের চরণ ॥ ৪১ ॥

mahā-bhāgavata-śreṣṭha datta uddhāraṇa
of great devotees the best Datta Uddhāraṇa
sarva-bhāve seve nityānandera caraṇa
in every way serves Nityānanda's feet

41 Uddhāraṇa Datta, the best of great devotees, served the feet of Nityānanda in every way.

Anubhāṣya.

Uddhāraṇa Datta. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 129): "He who in Vraja was the cowherd Subāhu is Datta, named Uddhāraṇa." He lived in Saptagrāma, on the bank of the river Sarasvatī near Triśabighā station in Hugalī district. Formerly "Saptagrāma" meant Vāsudevapura, Bāśaberiyā, Kṛṣṇapura, Nityānandapura, Śivapura, Śaṅkhanagara and Saptagrāma taken together. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Uddhāraṇa Datta is a great and generous Vaiṣṇava, who was given the right to serve Nityānanda." Antya, Chapter 5: "After staying some days at Khaḍadaha, Nityānanda came to Saptagrāma with all His associates. The best of lords stayed on the bank of the Triveṇī, in the temple of the fortunate Uddhāraṇa Datta. In body, mind and words Datta Uddhāraṇa served Nityānanda's feet without pretence. Through Uddhāraṇa the whole merchant community was purified — of this there is no doubt." By birth he belonged to a Suvarṇa-vaṇik family.

At Saptagrāma there is a six-armed form of Mahāprabhu, installed by Śrīla Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura and served by him with his own hands. To His right is Śrī Nityānanda and to His left Śrī Gadādhara. There are also forms of Śrī Rādhā-Govinda and a Śrī Śālagrāma, and beneath the throne-altar a painting of Śrī Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura Mahāśaya is worshipped. In front of the present temple is a large *nāṭya-mandira*. A memorial stone plaque on a pillar of the *nāṭya-mandira* bears the names of the builder of the temple and of those who restored the *śrīpāṭa*. Right in front of the *nāṭya-mandira* is a cool, shady *mādhavī* bower. On either side of the bower stand two pillars: on one is a painting of Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura Mahāśaya, and on the other, on a stone plaque, the four *tāraka-brahma-nāmas* of the four *yugas* are inscribed.

In 1283 a mendicant named Nitāidāsa Bābājī collected 12 *bighās* of land for the *śrīpāṭa*. Then, through the special efforts of certain people, the *śrīpāṭa* kept up for a while, but gradually the service fell into disorder. Later, in 1306, through the combined efforts of Balarāma Mallika, former Sub-judge of Hugalī, and many wealthy Suvarṇa-vaṇiks of Calcutta, some order is now seen again in the service of the *śrīpāṭa*.

Half a century ago a wooden image of Śrīla Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura, installed by the late Jagamohana Datta of Bāli in Hugalī, resided in a broken-down hut. That image is no longer at the Saptagrāma *śrīpāṭa*, and his painting is worshipped now. On in-

quiry we heard that Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura's former image is now in the house of Śrī Madana Datta Mahāśaya of Bāli, Hugalī, and the *śālagrāma* the Ṭhākura served is in the same village, in the house of Śrīnātha Datta.

Ṭhākura Uddhāraṇa was the *dewan* of the Rājā of the village of "Naihāṭī," 1½ miles north of Kāṭoyā. Near Dāĩhāṭ station the ruins of that royal family's palace can still be seen. The place where the Ṭhākura lived while serving the Rājā is still called "Uddhāraṇapura." It is said that the Śrī Nitāi-Gaura Deity the Ṭhākura installed here was taken to the capital of Banoyārībāda. West of the temple here (or, according to some, in Vṛndāvana) is the Ṭhākura's *samādhi*. According to some, the Ṭhākura's father was named Śrīkara, his mother Bhadrāvatī, and his son Śrīnivāsa.

(27) Vaiṣṇavānanda Ācārya —

আচার্য্য বৈষ্ণবানন্দ ভক্তি-অধিকারী ।
পূর্ব্বে নাম ছিল যাঁর 'রঘুনাথ পুরী' ॥ ৪২ ॥

ācārya vaiṣṇavānanda bhakti-adhikārī
Ācārya Vaiṣṇavānanda of devotion the possessor
pūrve nāma chila yāṁra 'raghunātha purī'
formerly name was whose 'Raghunātha Purī'

42 Ācārya Vaiṣṇavānanda was rich in devotion; his former name was Raghunātha Purī.

Anubhāṣya.

Vaiṣṇavānanda Ācārya. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*: "Ācārya Vaiṣṇavānanda is supremely generous; formerly he was known as 'Raghunātha Purī.'" The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 97), naming Raghunātha Purī among the eight Purīs, describes him as one of the eight *siddhis*, beginning with *aṇimā*.

(28) Viṣṇudāsa, Nandana, Gaṅgādāsa — three brothers —

বিষ্ণুদাস, নন্দন, গঙ্গাদাস — তিন ভাই ।
পূর্ব্বে যাঁর ঘরে ছিল ঠাকুর নিতাই ॥ ৪৩ ॥

viṣṇudāsa, nandana, gaṅgādāsa — tina bhāi
Viṣṇudāsa, Nandana, Gaṅgādāsa — three brothers
pūrve yāṁra ghare chila ṭhākura nitāi
formerly whose in the house stayed Ṭhākura Nitāi

43 Viṣṇudāsa, Nandana and Gaṅgādāsa were three brothers, in whose house Ṭhākura Nitāi once stayed.

Anubhāṣya.
Viṣṇudāsa, Nandana and Gaṅgādāsa were three brothers, Bhaṭṭācāryas of Navadvīpa. Viṣṇudāsa and Gaṅgādāsa stayed with Mahāprabhu at Nīlācala for some time (Ādi 10.151). Mahāprabhu and Advaita Prabhu hid in Nandana Ācārya's house. Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, on coming to Navadvīpa, also stayed there for a few days. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Gaṅgādāsa, the son of Caturbhuja Paṇḍita — in his house Nityānanda once sported."

(29) Paramānanda Upādhyāya, (30) Śrī Jīva Paṇḍita —

নিত্যানন্দভৃত্য — পরমানন্দ উপাধ্যায় ।
শ্রীজীব পণ্ডিত নিত্যানন্দ গুণ গায় ॥ ৪৪ ॥

nityānanda-bhṛtya — paramānanda upādhyāya
Nityānanda's servant — Paramānanda Upādhyāya
śrī-jīva paṇḍita nityānanda guṇa gāya
Śrī Jīva Paṇḍita Nityānanda's qualities sings

44 Paramānanda Upādhyāya was a servant of Nityānanda, and Śrī Jīva Paṇḍita sang of Nityānanda's virtues.

Anubhāṣya.
Paramānanda Upādhyāya. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Paramānanda Upādhyāya is an exclusively devoted Vaiṣṇava."

Śrī Jīva Paṇḍita was the middle son of Ratnagarbha Ācārya, a childhood friend of Hāḍāi Ojhā, Nityānanda's father. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "The generous Jīva Paṇḍita is a great devotee; in his house Nityānanda-candra sported." In Vraja he is Indirā (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verse 169).

(31) Paramānanda Gupta —

পরমানন্দ গুপ্ত — কৃষ্ণভক্ত মহামতি ।
পূর্ব্বে যাঁর ঘরে নিত্যানন্দের বসতি ॥ ৪৫ ॥

paramānanda gupta — kṛṣṇa-bhakta mahāmati
Paramānanda Gupta — Kṛṣṇa's devotee great-minded
pūrve yāṁra ghare nityānandera vasati
formerly whose in the house Nityānanda's dwelling

45 Paramānanda Gupta was a devotee of Kṛṣṇa, great in wisdom; Nityānanda once lived in his house.

Anubhāṣya.

Paramānanda Gupta. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Famous is Paramānanda Gupta Mahāśaya; formerly Nityānanda lived in his house." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verses 194 and 199) he is Mañjumedhā of Vraja: "The *Kṛṣṇa-stavāvalī* composed by Paramānanda Gupta."

(32) Nārāyaṇa, (33) Kṛṣṇadāsa, (34) Manohara, (35) Devānanda —

নারায়ণ, কৃষ্ণদাস, আর মনোহর ।
দেবানন্দ — চারি ভাই নিতাই-কিঙ্কর ॥ ৪৬ ॥

nārāyaṇa, kṛṣṇadāsa, āra manohara
Nārāyaṇa, Kṛṣṇadāsa, and Manohara
devānanda — cāri bhāi nitāi-kiṅkara
Devānanda — four brothers Nitāi's servants

46 Nārāyaṇa, Kṛṣṇadāsa, Manohara and Devānanda — these four brothers were servants of Nitāi.

Anubhāṣya.

Nārāyaṇa, Kṛṣṇadāsa, Manohara and Devānanda. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Kṛṣṇadāsa and Devānanda are two pure-hearted ones. Dear to Nityānanda are these four: 'Manohara,' 'Nārāyaṇa,' 'Kṛṣṇadāsa' and 'Devānanda.'"

(36) Hoḍa Kṛṣṇadāsa —

হোড় কৃষ্ণদাস — নিত্যানন্দপ্রভু-প্রাণ ।
শ্রীনিত্যানন্দ-পদ বিনা নাহি জানে আন ॥ ৪৭ ॥

hoḍa kṛṣṇadāsa — nityānanda-prabhu-prāṇa
Hoḍa Kṛṣṇadāsa — Nityānanda Prabhu his life
śrī-nityānanda-pada vinā nāhi jāne āna
Śrī Nityānanda's feet but not knows another

47 To Hoḍa Kṛṣṇadāsa, Nityānanda Prabhu was life itself; he knew nothing but the feet of Śrī Nityānanda.

Anubhāṣya.

Hoḍa Kṛṣṇadāsa. "Kṛṣṇadāsa of Baḍagāchi, rich in pious merit, in whose temple Nityānanda sported"; the same place tells of the glory of Baḍagāchi (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6). See below, "Navanī Hoḍa."

(37) Nakaḍi, (38) Mukunda, (39) Sūrya, (40) Mādhava, (41) Śrīdhara (gopāla 12), (42) Rāmānanda, (43) Jagannātha, (44) Mahīdhara —

নকড়ি, মুকুন্দ, সূর্য্য, মাধব, শ্রীধর ।
রামানন্দ বসু, জগন্নাথ, মহীধর ॥ ৪৮ ॥

nakaḍi, mukunda, sūrya, mādhava, śrīdhara
Nakaḍi, Mukunda, Sūrya, Mādhava, Śrīdhara
rāmānanda vasu, jagannātha, mahīdhara
Rāmānanda Vasu, Jagannātha, Mahīdhara

48 Among Nityānanda's devotees were also Nakaḍi, Mukunda, Sūrya, Mādhava, Śrīdhara, Rāmānanda Vasu, Jagannātha and Mahīdhara;

(45) Śrīmanta, (46) Gokuladāsa, (47) Hariharānanda, (48) Śivāi, (49) Nandāi, (50) Paramānanda —

শ্রীমন্ত, গোকুলদাস, হরিহরানন্দ ।
শিবাই, নন্দাই, অবধূত পরমানন্দ ॥ ৪৯ ॥

śrīmanta, gokula-dāsa, hariharānanda
Śrīmanta, Gokuladāsa, Hariharānanda
śivāi, nandāi, avadhūta paramānanda
Śivāi, Nandāi, the Avadhūta Paramānanda

49 Śrīmanta, Gokuladāsa, Hariharānanda, Śivāi, Nandāi and Paramānanda the Avadhūta;

(51) Vasanta, (52) Navanī, (53) Gopāla, (54) Sanātana, (55) Viṣṇāi, (56) Kṛṣṇānanda, (57) Sulocana —

বসন্ত, নবনী হোড়, গোপাল, সনাতন ৷
বিষ্ণাই হাজরা, কৃষ্ণানন্দ, সুলোচন ॥ ৫০ ॥

vasanta, navanī hoḍa, gopāla, sanātana
Vasanta, Navanī Hoḍa, Gopāla, Sanātana
viṣṇāi hājarā, kṛṣṇānanda, sulocana
Viṣṇāi Hājarā, Kṛṣṇānanda, Sulocana

50 Vasanta, Navanī Hoḍa, Gopāla, Sanātana, Viṣṇāi Hājarā, Kṛṣṇānanda and Sulocana;

Anubhāṣya.
Navanī Hoḍa. Rājā Kṛṣṇadāsa Hoḍa, the son of Hari Hoḍa, lived in Baḍagāchi. Baḍagāchi (Bahiragāchi) lies on the Lālagolā-ghāṭ line of the E.B.R., two miles from Muḍāgāchā station, across from Dharmadaha, on the bank of the "Guḍaguḍe" canal. In nearby Śāligrāma, through Rājā Kṛṣṇadāsa's efforts, the wedding of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu took place (*Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 12). "Rukuṇapura" is a short distance from Bahiragāchi. Kṛṣṇadāsa's son was Navanī Hoḍa. His descendants now live in Rukuṇapura. By birth they are Dakṣiṇa-Rāḍhīya Kāyasthas; having received brahminical *saṁskāras*, they give initiation to people of all *varṇas*. In former times the Gaṅgā flowed at Baḍagāchi; that channel is now known as the "Kālśira canal."

Kṛṣṇānanda: see section 35.

(58) Kaṁsāri, (59) Rāmasena, (60) Rāmacandra, (61) Govinda, (62) Śrīraṅga,

(63) Mukunda —

কংসারি সেন, রামসেন, রামচন্দ্র কবিরাজ ।
গোবিন্দ, শ্রীরঙ্গ, মুকুন্দ, তিন কবিরাজ ॥ ৫১ ॥

kaṁsāri sena, rāmasena, rāmacandra kavirāja
Kaṁsāri Sena, Rāmasena, Rāmacandra Kavirāja
govinda, śrīraṅga, mukunda, tina kavirāja
Govinda, Śrīraṅga, Mukunda, three kavirājas

51 Kaṁsāri Sena, Rāmasena and Rāmacandra Kavirāja, and the three physicians — Govinda, Śrīraṅga and Mukunda;

Anubhāṣya.

Kaṁsāri Sena is "Ratnāvalī" of Vraja. See the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verses 194 and 200, and "Sadāśiva Kavirāja" above.

Rāmacandra Kavirāja was the son of Cirañjīva and Sunandā of Khaṇḍa, a disciple of Śrīnivāsa Ācārya, and a dear friend of Ṭhākura Narottama. Ṭhākura Narottama prayed for his company birth after birth. His younger brother was Govinda Kavirāja. Seeing his devotion to Kṛṣṇa, Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī Prabhu gave him the name "Kavirāja" in Vṛndāvana. From birth he was detached from worldly life, and he was the chief and dearest companion of Ṭhākura Mahāśaya and Śrīnivāsa Ācārya Prabhu in preaching and in *bhajana*. He lived first in Śrīkhaṇḍa and later came to "Kumāranagara" on the bank of the Bhāgīrathī and settled there (see the *Bhakti-ratnākara*).

Govinda Kavirāja was the younger son of Cirañjīva of Khaṇḍa and the brother of Rāmacandra Kavirāja. At first he was a Śākta; later he was initiated by Śrīnivāsa Ācārya Prabhu. He lived first in Śrīkhaṇḍa, then in Kumāranagara, and later came to the village of "Teliyā Budhari" on the south bank of the Padmā and settled there. Seeing his poetic gift, Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī Prabhu gave him too the name "Kavirāja." He is the author of the drama *Saṅgīta-mādhava*, the *Gītāmṛta* and other works (see the *Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 9).

(64) Pītāmbara, (65) Mādhavācārya, (66) Dāmodara, (67) Śaṅkara, (68)

Mukunda, (69) Jñānadāsa, (70) Manohara —

পীতাম্বর, মাধবাচার্য্য, দাস দামোদর ।
শঙ্কর, মুকুন্দ, জ্ঞানদাস, মনোহর ॥ ৫২ ॥

pītāmbara, mādhavācārya, dāsa dāmodara
Pītāmbara, Mādhavācārya, Dāsa Dāmodara
śaṅkara, mukunda, jñāna-dāsa, manohara
Śaṅkara, Mukunda, Jñānadāsa, Manohara

52 Pītāmbara, Mādhavācārya, Dāmodara dāsa, Śaṅkara, Mukunda, Jñānadāsa and Manohara;

(71) Gopāla, (72) Rāmabhadra, (73) Gaurāṅgadāsa, (74) Nṛsiṁha-caitanya, (75) Mīnaketana —

নর্ত্তক গোপাল, রামভদ্র, গৌরাঙ্গদাস ।
নৃসিংহচৈতন্য, মীনকেতন রামদাস ॥ ৫৩ ॥

nartaka gopāla, rāmabhadra, gaurāṅga-dāsa
the dancer Gopāla, Rāmabhadra, Gaurāṅgadāsa
nṛsiṁha-caitanya, mīnaketana rāmadāsa
Nṛsiṁha-caitanya, Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa

53 Gopāla the dancer, Rāmabhadra, Gaurāṅgadāsa, Nṛsiṁha-caitanya and Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa.

Anubhāṣya.
Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 68): “For a purpose the two born together, Niśaṭha and Ulmuka, entered him. Mīnaketana Rāma[7] is another *vyūha* of Saṅkarṣaṇa.”

(76) Śrī Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa —

বৃন্দাবনদাস — নারায়ণীর নন্দন ।
‘চৈতন্য-মঙ্গল’ যেঁহো করিল রচন ॥ ৫৪ ॥

vṛndāvana-dāsa — nārāyaṇīra nandana
Vṛndāvana dāsa — Nārāyaṇī's son
'caitanya-maṅgala' yeṁho karila racana
'Caitanya-maṅgala' who composed

54 Vṛndāvana dāsa, the son of Nārāyaṇī, composed the *Caitanya-maṅgala*.[3]

Anubhāṣya.
Vṛndāvana dāsa. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 109): "He who was Vedavyāsa is now Vṛndāvana dāsa. For a purpose, [Kṛṣṇa's] friend Kusumāpīḍa also entered him." He is the son of Nārāyaṇī, the daughter of Śrīvāsa's brother, and the author of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*. See the essay "The Ṭhākura's Life" in the introduction to the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* written by the author of this commentary.

Vyāsadeva described Kṛṣṇa's pastimes in the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, and [Vṛndāvana dāsa] Gaura's pastimes in the Caitanya-bhāgavata —

ভাগবতে কৃষ্ণলীলা বর্ণিলা বেদব্যাস ।
চৈতন্য-লীলাতে ব্যাস — বৃন্দাবন দাস ॥ ৫৫ ॥

bhāgavate kṛṣṇalīlā varṇilā vedavyāsa
in the Bhāgavata Kṛṣṇa's pastimes described Vedavyāsa
caitanya-līlāte vyāsa — vṛndāvana dāsa
in Caitanya's pastimes the Vyāsa — Vṛndāvana dāsa

55 Veda-vyāsa described the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa in the *Bhāgavata*; the Vyāsa of Caitanya's pastimes is Vṛndāvana dāsa.

The branch of Vīrabhadra Gosāñi is the best of all —

সর্ব্বশাখা-শ্রেষ্ঠ বীরভদ্র গোসাঞি ।
তাঁর উপশাখা যত, তার অন্ত নাই ॥ ৫৬ ॥

sarvaśākhā-śreṣṭha vīrabhadra gosāñi
of all branches the best Vīrabhadra Gosāñi
tāṁra upaśākhā yata, tāra anta nāi
His offshoots as many, of them end there is not

56 Vīrabhadra Gosāñi is the best of all the branches, and His offshoots are without end.

Nityānanda's associates are countless; [the author] glorifies their qualities to purify himself —

অনন্ত নিত্যানন্দগণ — কে করু গণন ।
আত্মপবিত্রতা-হেতু লিখিলাঙ কত জন ॥ ৫৭ ॥

ananta nityānanda-gaṇa — ke karu gaṇana
endless Nityānanda's devotees — who can count
ātma-pavitratā-hetu likhilāṅa kata jana
self-purification for the sake of I have written of some persons

57 Nityānanda's devotees are endless — who could count them? I have written of some of them for my own purification.

They deliver the world by giving love for Kṛṣṇa —

এই সর্ব্বশাখা পূর্ণ — পক্ক-প্রেমফলে ।
যারে দেখে, তারে দিয়া ভাসাইল সকলে ॥ ৫৮ ॥

ei sarva-śākhā pūrṇa — pakva-prema-phale
these all branches full — with ripe fruits of love
yāre dekhe, tāre diyā bhāsāila sakale
whom they see, to him giving flooded everyone

58 All these branches are laden with the ripe fruits of love. They gave them to whomever they met and flooded all with love.

The deeds of their direct love for Kṛṣṇa —

অনর্গল প্রেম সবার, চেষ্টা অনর্গল ।
প্রেম দিতে, কৃষ্ণ দিতে (সবে) ধরে মহাবল ॥ ৫৯ ॥

anargala prema sabāra, ceṣṭā anargala
unbounded love of all, endeavour unbounded
prema dite, kṛṣṇa dite (sabe) dhare mahābala
love to give, Kṛṣṇa to give (all) hold great power

59 Their love knows no bounds, nor does their striving; each of them has great power to give love and to give Kṛṣṇa Himself.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the eleventh chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

সংক্ষেপে কহিলাঙ এই নিত্যানন্দ-গণ ।
যাঁহার অবধি না পায় 'সহস্র-বদন' ॥ ৬০ ॥

saṅkṣepe kahilāṅ ei nityānanda-gaṇa
in brief I have told these Nityānanda's devotees
yāṁhāra avadhi nā pāya 'sahasra-vadana'
whose limit not reaches 'the thousand-mouthed'

60 Thus I have told in brief of Nityānanda's devotees, whose limit even the thousand-mouthed Ananta cannot reach.

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ৬১ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

61 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. "His side" is Nityānanda's: by verse 14, Mahāprabhu sent these two to Gauḍa with Him; so too the edition's heading to verse 14: "Together with Nitāi both

preach in Gauḍa.” ↩

2. *Dāna-keli*, “the toll pastime”: Kṛṣṇa and His friends block the gopīs’ way and demand a “toll” from them. ↩
3. *Caitanya-maṅgala* was the first name of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (see Ādi 8.33–35). ↩
4. The edition reads *revata-vaṁśa*, “the line of Revata” (Revata, also called Kakudmī, is Revatī’s father). Possibly *revaty-aṁśa* should be read: “born of portions of Vāruṇī and Revatī.” ↩
5. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* itself (Madhya 1.296) reads “a companion of the Prabhu’s father,” that is, from the context, of Jagannātha Miśra. Below (on verse 44) the edition again calls Ratnagarbha a childhood friend of Hāḍāi Ojhā, Nityānanda’s father. ↩
6. So in the edition (*dvādaśa varṣera*, “of twelve years”). Yet just below it says that in his fifth year the child had already gone with Mother Jāhnavā to Vṛndāvana. ↩
7. The edition reads *mīnaketana-rāmādir vyūhaḥ*, literally “Mīnaketana Rāma and the others are a *vyūha*”; translated according to the sense. ↩